

BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

OpenClaw Terminal Setup Cheat Sheet

Build Your AI CEO: The Complete Setup Guide

MODULE 4 — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Every Question the Wizard Asks — and Exactly What to Answer

Before You Start

Run this command to launch the setup wizard:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw onboard --install-daemon
```

The wizard will walk you through setup one question at a time. This cheat sheet gives you the answer to every question, in the exact order they appear.

⚠ The Straight Quotes Rule (Read This First)

When you type or paste commands into Terminal, always use **straight quotes** — not curly quotes.

Pages and word processors auto-convert your quotes into curly quotes. Curly quotes break Terminal commands.

- ✅ Straight quotes (use these): " ' "
- ❌ Curly quotes (these break it): " " ' ' "

If a command fails and you can't figure out why — check your quotes first. This causes 80% of Terminal errors.

Step-by-Step: Every Wizard Prompt

STEP 1 — Existing Config Check

What you'll see:

If this is your first time, the wizard moves straight to Step 2. You won't see this prompt.

If you've run OpenClaw before, it may ask:

"Config already exists. Keep, Modify, or Reset?"

✅ **Answer:** — if your config is working. — only if starting completely fresh.

Why: Choosing Reset wipes your existing setup. Only do this if you want to start over from scratch.

STEP 2 — QuickStart vs Advanced

What you'll see:

"QuickStart (recommended defaults) or Advanced (full control)?"

✅ **Answer:**

Why: QuickStart sets smart defaults for everything — port, bind address, auth mode, and security settings. You don't need to configure those manually. Advanced mode exposes every setting, which is overwhelming when you're just getting started.

STEP 3 — Choose Your AI Provider

What you'll see:

A numbered list of AI providers. Something like:

1. Anthropic (Claude) — API key
2. OpenAI — API key
3. xAI (Grok) — API key
4. OpenCode
5. Ollama (local models)
6. Custom provider
7. Skip

✅ **Answer:** Select **Anthropic (Claude) — API key**

Why: This course uses Claude Sonnet, which runs on Anthropic. You need an Anthropic API key. If you haven't gotten your API key yet, pause here and complete Module 2 first.

STEP 4 — Enter Your API Key

What you'll see:

"Enter your Anthropic API key:"

✅ **Answer:** Paste your Anthropic API key here.

Your key looks like this: `sk-ant-api03-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`

How to get it: Go to console.anthropic.com → API Keys → Create Key.

⚠️ *The cursor won't move while you paste. That's normal — Terminal hides API keys for security. Just paste and press Enter.*

STEP 5 — Choose Your Default Model

What you'll see:

A list of available models. Something like:

1. claude-sonnet-4-6 (recommended)
2. claude-opus-4-6
3. claude-haiku-4-6
4. Enter manually

✅ **Answer:** Select **claude-sonnet-4-6** (or whichever option says "recommended" or "Sonnet")

Why: Claude Sonnet is the right balance of capability and cost. Opus is more powerful but significantly more expensive. Haiku is faster and cheaper but less capable for complex AI CEO tasks.

STEP 6 — Workspace Location

What you'll see:

```
"Where should your workspace live? [~/openclaw/workspace]"
```

✅ **Answer:** Option A or Option B below — choose one.

Option A — Use the default location (easiest):

Just press **Enter** without typing anything.

Your workspace will be at: `~/openclaw/workspace`

Option B — Use a custom location:

Type your preferred path, for example:

```
/Users/your-username/workspace
```

Why: The workspace is the folder where all your AI's identity files, memory, and operating documents live. The default location works perfectly. Use a custom path only if you have a specific reason.

How to find your username: Type `whoami` in Terminal and press Enter. It prints your Mac username.

STEP 7 — Gateway Port

What you'll see:

```
"Gateway port: [18789]"
```

✅ **Answer:** Press **Enter** to accept the default (`18789`).

Why: The port is the "door" OpenClaw listens on. The default (`18789`) is what all documentation, apps, and integrations expect. Only change this if port 18789 is already in use on your machine (which is very rare).

STEP 8 — Gateway Bind Address

What you'll see:

"Bind address: [127.0.0.1]"

✓ **Answer:** Press **Enter** to accept the default (`127.0.0.1`).

Why: This controls who on your network can reach OpenClaw. `127.0.0.1` means only your own computer — the most secure setting. Do not change this to `0.0.0.0` unless you specifically need other devices on your network to connect.

STEP 9 — Gateway Auth Mode

What you'll see:

"Auth mode: Token, Password, or None?"

✓ **Answer:** `Token`

Why: Token auth adds a security layer so only authorized clients can connect to your gateway. This is the recommended and safest option. Choosing "None" means anything running on your computer can access OpenClaw without any verification.

STEP 10 — Generate Token

What you'll see:

"Generate a token automatically?"

✓ **Answer:** `Yes` (or press Enter if Yes is the default)

Why: OpenClaw will generate a secure random token for you. You don't need to memorize or write this down — OpenClaw manages it automatically.

STEP 11 — Tailscale Exposure

What you'll see:

"Enable Tailscale VPN exposure?"

✓ **Answer:**

Why: Tailscale is a VPN tool for accessing your AI remotely from other devices or locations. Skip this for now unless you specifically set up Tailscale in Module 3. You can always enable it later.

STEP 12 — Channel Setup

What you'll see:

A list of messaging channels to set up:

1. Discord
2. Telegram
3. WhatsApp
4. Signal
5. iMessage
6. Slack
7. Skip

✓ **Answer:** Select **Discord**

Why: This course uses Discord as your primary command channel — the place where you send instructions to your AI CEO and receive updates. You set up your Discord bot and server in Module 3.

STEP 13 — Discord Bot Token

What you'll see:

"Enter your Discord bot token:"

✓ **Answer:** Paste your Discord bot token here.

Your token looks like this: `MTI4NDM0NjI4MjQ2NzYwNzY2Ng.GxxxxX.xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`

How to get it: Discord Developer Portal → Your App → Bot → Reset Token → Copy.

⚠ *Just like the API key, the cursor won't move while you paste. Paste and press Enter.*

STEP 14 — Discord Server / Channel Access

What you'll see:

OpenClaw may ask for your Discord Server ID or prompt you to select which channels to allow.

✅ **Answer:** Enter your Discord Server (Guild) ID.

How to find your Server ID:

1. Open Discord
2. Go to User Settings → Advanced → Enable **Developer Mode**
3. Right-click your server name in the left sidebar
4. Click "**Copy Server ID**"
5. Paste it here

STEP 15 — Daemon Install (Background Service)

What you'll see:

"Install OpenClaw as a background service (LaunchAgent)?"

✅ **Answer:**

Why: Installing as a LaunchAgent means OpenClaw starts automatically when you log in to your Mac — just like any other app that runs in the background. Without this, you would have to manually start OpenClaw every time you restart your computer. This is what makes your AI CEO "always on."

STEP 16 — Health Check

What you'll see:

OpenClaw will automatically start the gateway and run a health check. You'll see something like:

```
✓ Gateway is running on port 18789
✓ Discord: connected
✓ Model: claude-sonnet-4-6 — ready
```

✅ **Answer:** No action needed. This step runs automatically.

If you see ❌ errors here, check:

- Your API key is correct (no extra spaces)
- Your Discord bot token is correct
- Port 18789 isn't blocked by another application

STEP 17 — Skills Setup

What you'll see:

"Install recommended skills?"

✅ **Answer:**

Then it will ask:

"Which node manager: npm, pnpm, or bun?"

✅ **Answer:**

Why: Skills are optional add-ons that give your AI extra capabilities (like weather lookups, Discord ops, and more). Installing the recommended set gives you a solid starting toolkit. npm is the standard package manager and the safest choice for most users.

STEP 18 — Setup Complete

What you'll see:

A summary screen confirming everything is configured. Something like:

```
✓ OpenClaw is running
✓ Gateway: http://127.0.0.1:18789
✓ Discord: configured
✓ LaunchAgent: installed
```

✅ **Answer:** Setup is done.

Verify it's working:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw gateway status
```

You should see "running" and the port number.

Quick Troubleshooting

"openclaw: command not found"

Your terminal session hasn't loaded the new installation yet. Run:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
source ~/.zshrc
```

Or close and reopen your Terminal window.

API key is rejected / "Authentication failed"

- Make sure there are no extra spaces before or after the key
- Confirm the key is from console.anthropic.com and is active
- Try running `openclaw configure` to re-enter it

Discord bot not connecting

- Re-check your bot token in the Discord Developer Portal
- Make sure the bot has been added to your server with proper permissions
- Confirm Developer Mode is on and you have the correct Server ID

Gateway won't start / "Port already in use"

Another application is using port 18789. Either close that application, or change the port:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw configure
```

Something looks wrong — how do I reset?

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw onboard --reset
```

This lets you redo the setup without losing your workspace files.

After Setup: Key Commands

What you want to do	Command
Check if OpenClaw is running	<code>openclaw gateway status</code>
Restart the gateway	<code>openclaw gateway restart</code>
Open the web dashboard	<code>openclaw dashboard</code>
Reconfigure settings	<code>openclaw configure</code>
View live logs	<code>openclaw gateway logs</code>
Add another channel	<code>openclaw channels login</code>

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